

computers, and if you do you will probably use the same browser on all of them. If that browser happens to be Google Chrome, then you will be pleased to know that it has a Synchronization feature built in. You can keep your browser customisations synchronised among multiple computers using Google Chrome Sync.

Over the past few versions of Google Chrome, the browser has gained support for syncing an increasing amount of data. It started from simply synchronizing bookmarks in Google Chrome 4, and today, in the latest Google Chrome 8 it supports synchronising preferences, Autofill data, Themes, extensions, and apps in addition to bookmarks.

Google Chrome Sync requires a Google Account, and stores your data in your Google Docs account. It is easy to enable, as an option is available for it under the “Personal Stuff” tab of your Preferences page. There you can enable or disable sync and choose what all you’d like to keep synced.

In Chrome 9 (currently in the dev channel) it is possible to synchronise passwords as well, and adding and additional sync key for encrypting your data.

Run Greasemonkey scripts

Greasemonkey is like an add-on that makes your browser extensible in yet another way.

These scripts run on web pages and can often add features that are not available by default. For example, you will find Greasemonkey scripts that add a download button to YouTube, preview audio files stored in Google Docs, or show prices in your local currency on Amazon. Since these scripts run in the context of the web site itself, many of these can be run on any browser, and there have always been ways

of doing so. The great thing is that Greasemonkey scripts are natively supported on Google Chrome, without installing any add-on.

To install Greasemonkey scripts, visit <http://userscripts.org> and search away for the scripts you want. Once you find a script, just click the Install button, and Google Chrome will show the usual Google Chrome extension installation dialog. You will be able to manage your installed Greasemonkey scripts along with the rest of your extensions.

Private browsing

Often times we need to perform activities on our browser that we’d rather keep private. For this purpose many browser include a mode of browsing in which no records are kept of a user’s activities.

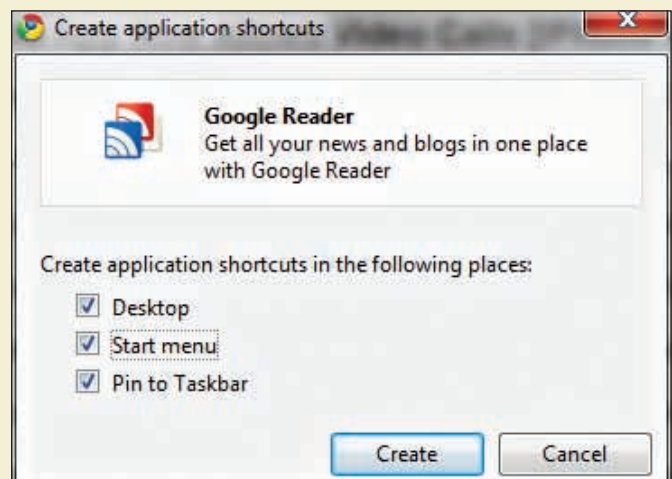
If you want, you can simply create a new profile for this purpose, however a simpler way is



For enhanced privacy, go incognito

to use the “Incognito” feature in Google Chrome. Unlike in Firefox, Google Chrome can open a new “Incognito window” along with your usual browsing session, whereas in Firefox, your normal browsing session would be suspended.

Whatever you do in tabs opened in this incognito window is not recorded, it is as if you are working on



Create shortcuts for your applications

a read-only copy of your browser. Read-only means that your browsing history and bookmarks are still available (unlike with the separate profile approach), however they are not affected by your activities while private browsing is engaged.

Google Chrome disables extensions in Incognito mode since they might inadvert-

You can also use the shortcut [Ctrl]+[Shift]+[N].

Create single-site browsers

Google Chrome has inbuilt support for creating single-site browsers. What this means is, you can create a direct shortcut to a web site you like on your desktop, start menu, or pinned to your taskbar, clicking on which will open the web site in its own window, as if it were a normal desktop application. Such windows will not even have the minimal UI that Google Chrome has. They are simple windows with a title bar and the content of the web page.

This can be incredibly useful for web applications such as Gmail, or Aviary. If one application crashes, it will not bring down the other applications or the tabs opened in Google Chrome. Additionally, each such application will appear as a separate icon in the task bar instead of grouping with your other Google Chrome Windows.

Creating such a web application shortcut is simple, click on the wrench-menu, and under the “Tools” submenu, you will find “Create application shortcuts...”. Clicking on this will pop up a dialog that will give you the option to create short-